

Session 5: Discovering Customer Needs

Key Points...

1. The place to start when marketing is customer NEEDS.
 - Start by identifying customer needs, then build your marketing around them.
 - Don't make the mistake of starting with what YOU think is great about what you sell.
 - Customers only care about their NEEDS.
2. Customer needs are often hidden – so you must DIG.
 - We humans like to assume that we "get" others - and we know what they're thinking.
 - Turns out that we're not as good at this as we think.
3. There's real money on the line here, so it's time to get serious.
 - The price of a mistake when identifying Customer Needs is high - and the reward great.
 - The probability of successfully identifying customer needs is low - unless you talk to them one-one-one.
4. What are the basic "irrational" human needs that drive us?
 - Maclean's 3 Brains.
 - Survival, Reproduction, and Status.
 - Maslow's Hierarchy - There are two types of needs: deficiency and being. The deficiency needs MUST get fulfilled. It's not optional. We'll do anything to get those needs met. When we meet a deficiency need, then the next deficiency need up the ladder emerges. (From survival, to safety, to security, to love, to self-expression). Our customers are mostly driven by deficiency needs. They don't appear to be optional to the average human. (I need to sell my guys on the level they're at, survival and security, and only down the road teach them how to be all they can be, their self-actualization needs).
5. If you want to "get it right," you must talk to customers.
 - The fastest way to discover needs that you can fulfill with your marketing is to ASK.
 - You'll learn more by talking to a Prospective Customer for 15 minutes than you will "thinking about it" all day long.
 - Invest a lot of your time and energy into talking to customers. Do this every day. It'll pay off. Ask them for their fears and frustrations, wants and aspirations, etc.
6. You're looking for emotional needs that are going unmet.
 - As you research and consider customer needs, pay special attention to those that are going unmet.
 - A need that isn't met is far more powerful than a need that is being met.